

But at that point, the ideas were already out there, so “taking care of you,” wouldn’t have done anything for them anyway.

It would have been useless, and they realized that.

Some years ago, I read a book called *Eudaemonic Pie* about a group of physics students who also developed a shoe computer using Newtonian physics to predict the most likely outcome for roulette spins. Was there any connection between you and them?

Here is the connection. In the second edition of *Beat the Dealer*, I mentioned there was a way to win at roulette. In 1969, I got a call from a mathematician named Ralph Abraham inquiring about a roulette system. At that time, I thought that I would never use it myself again, so I might as well let the information out. Within a few years, some physics graduate students did the same thing. They had the next generation of electronics and arrived at the same 44 percent edge.

Let’s go back to blackjack. Was your article published in a scientific journal?

It was published in 1961 in the *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*.

What was the response?

There wasn’t so much a response to that article as there was to a talk I gave at the same time at the annual meeting of the American Mathematical Society. I submitted an abstract of the talk called *Fortune’s Formula: A Winning Strategy for Blackjack*. The abstract committee reviewed my proposal, and unbeknownst to me at the time, they were going to reject it as the work of another crank. They get a lot of submissions from people purporting to prove the mathematically impossible, such as proofs for trisecting an angle with a compass and straight edge alone, or gambling systems for games that are impossible to beat.

Did they read your paper?

The paper wasn’t out yet. All they had was the abstract. Fortunately, one of the members on the abstract committee was a number theorist, John Selfridge, whom I had worked with at UCLA. He told the committee, “I